

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Mrs Arifa Khan

Address: 4 Thorn Court Grange Road Sutton SM2 6RP

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: As a resident of the London Borough of Sutton, I would like to register my strong support for application DM2025/01591. This is a constructive proposal for a site that has been unoccupied for too long.

Half of all users are expected to walk. Only around one in eight drives alone. These are remarkably sustainable travel patterns, and they mean the actual parking and traffic impact will be much lower than the raw attendance numbers might suggest.

The mix of uses in this application is what makes it so valuable. The community hub element will host activities for all residents, making it a shared neighbourhood resource rather than a facility for one group. It is not a single-use building.

Additionally, the statutory Biodiversity Net Gain threshold is met, and the scheme includes external greening and landscaping that will improve the ecological value of what is currently a largely hard-surfaced, unoccupied site. The proposal delivers environmental improvements alongside community benefits.

The NPPF requires planning authorities to plan positively for community infrastructure. Sutton's Local Plan echoes this requirement. This application is supported at every level of the policy hierarchy, and I would expect the Council to give that due weight.

Bringing it back into productive use for the benefit of the community is far better than leaving it to deteriorate. The former ambulance station is a brownfield site that has been empty since the NHS

declared it surplus to requirements. The NPPF and London Plan both encourage the reuse of previously developed land, and this proposal does exactly that.

This proposal ticks every box: it is policy-compliant, well-evidenced, and really needed. I urge the Council to grant planning permission for DM2025/01591.